

GP-49-HI

Apr 1944

RETURN TO

HQ USAFHRC

MAXWELL AFB AL 36112-6678

SCANNED BY AC

2026

SCANNED BY ACD

2006

5281-11

00080051

GP 49- HZ APR., 1944 J
RETURN TO RESEARCH STUDIES INSTITUTE U.S.A.F. HISTORICAL DIVISION ARCHIVES BRANCH

SCANNED BY ACD

2006

P.R.C.

5281-11

00080051

~~CONFIDENTIAL~~

DECLASSIFIED
DOD DIR 5200.9

49th Fighter Group
apr 1944

THIS PAGE IS DECLASSIFIED IAW EO 13526

THIS PAGE IS DECLASSIFIED IAW EO 13526

GP-49-H1.
1 APR 44
HEADQUARTERS 49TH FIGHTER GROUP
ARMY AIR FORCES
APO 565

30 May, 1944.

GROUP HISTORICAL RECORDS (April 1944)

TO : Commanding General, Fifth Air Force, APO 925.

1. Strength.

a. Personnel, Commissioned and enlisted.

	OFFICERS		<u>ENLISTED MEN</u>
	<u>FLYING</u>	<u>GROUND</u>	
<u>1.</u> At beginning of period	4	17	60
<u>2.</u> Net increase during period	00	0	10
<u>3.</u> Net decrease during period	0	1	0
<u>4.</u> At end of period	4	16	70

2. Aircraft : None with unit.

3. Ground battles engaged in by unit - Nil.


Robert J. Boniece
ROBERT J. BONIECE,
1st Lt., Air Corps,
Historical Officer.DECLASSIFIED
DOD DIR 5200.9

1314-2

1008005-1

5281-11

HEADQUARTERS 49TH FIGHTER GROUP
ARMY AIR FORCES
APO 920.

26 June, 1944.

SUBJECT: April Historical Edition.

TO : Historical Officer, Headquarters, V Fighter Command, APO 713,
Unit 1.

1. The month of April opened rather slow for the 49th as compared to previous periods. However, the Patron Saint of all SNAFU's, TARFU's and SUSFU's lurked in the background working on plans for our next move.

2. Speculation on events "up the line" especially at Hollandia and Tadji was rampant. The final drive to push the Nips from New Guinea seemed in forceful motion. The 49th was somewhat disappointed at not being in on the action up the coast. We had to be satisfied with the necessary milk runs and divebombing and strafing missions at Barapop, Mariu and Tirabu.

3. The 9th Squadron were busy going back to the P-38 in exchange for P-47s. The pilots were happy to make the swap. Moral went up as they became reacquainted with the P-38's and checked them for future action.

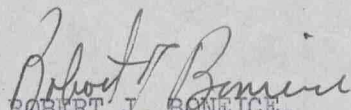
4. Packing went on with the usual confusion of sorting and re-sorting to lighten the load. The men were gleefully running about with a hammer in one hand and a new carbine in the other. This exchange of the heavier rifle for the lighter Carbine was without regret.

5. Meanwhile further experiments were being carried on with the incendiary belly tanks. The 7th Squadron dropped thirty-two of the new type belly tank bombs during the month with increasing accuracy and results. The suggestion by the pilots of addition of fins to the tanks is being worked on.

6. On 18 April the outfit was split into Ground and Air Echelons for the next move. Little did we realize just how well separated these units would become.

7. On 19 April the Ground Echelon left via air transport for Finschafen leaving the air echelon behind.

8. The close of the month found the ground echelon mired in the mud at Finschafen awaiting transportation to Hollandia.


ROBERT J. BONEICE,
1st Lt., Air Corps,
Historical Officer.

